READING PART 3

Opinion Matching

Task Overview

In part 3, you will read four people's opinions on the same topic. You will have to match these with the 7 questions provided.

Key points:

- There are 7 questions.
- Each paragraph matches at least one question.
- Some paragraphs may match two or three questions.
- You are matching ideas and attitudes — not identical words.

General strategy

- Read the questions first and identify the key idea in each one.
- Work paragraph by paragraph: match what you can, then move on.
- Be careful with distractors. A paragraph may mention a topic without answering the question.
- Watch out for repeated words. One person may use the same word as a question, but it is not the answer.
- Look for paraphrases: different wording, same meaning.

In this chapter, you will:

- Learn practical strategies to approach Reading Part 3
- Analyse a guided example step by step
- Complete an additional practice task

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Guided Reading Task

In this example, you will see how to match one paragraph to the correct questions — and avoid distractors.

Streaming Services and Entertainment

Four people respond in the comments section of an online magazine article about streaming services and how people watch TV and films. Read the texts and answer the questions.

Step 1: Read Marcus's paragraph

Marcus

Streaming suits me because it removes the timetable. If I'm busy, I can pause a film and finish it days later without missing anything, and I don't have to plan my evening around a broadcast; that's totally the biggest change, I think. That and skipping the awful ads! I also enjoy the back catalogue — it used to be impossible to find classic movies. But, it's just so expensive having so many subscriptions at the same time!

Which of the following questions match Marcus?

a. Who mentions a strategy to cut down on expenses?

b. Who values the flexibility of streaming services?

c. Who highlights the advantage of access to older content?

d. Who enjoys being able to watch blockbuster movies?

Answers and explanations:

A: Incorrect: Marcus complains that subscriptions are expensive, but he does not describe a strategy (e.g., cancelling/rotating) to reduce costs.
B: Correct: Marcus says streaming "removes the timetable" and he can pause and finish a film later — this matches flexibility.
C: Correct: Marcus mentions the "back catalogue" and "classic movies" — this matches access to older content.
D: Incorrect: Marcus refers to "classic movies" (older content), not blockbuster films.

Step 2: Question analysis

Read all seven questions carefully and decide which words express the main meaning.
Try to rephrase each question in your own words before reading the texts.

1. Who feels that having too many options can be counterproductive?
2. Who values the flexibility of streaming services?
3. Who worries about the impact on wellbeing and daily routines?
4. Who mentions a strategy to cut down on expenses?
5. Who misses a shared cultural experience around TV programmes?
6. Who highlights the advantage of access to older content?
7. Who describes using personal rules with their viewing habits?

Possible rephrasing:

1. Too much choice / not efficient, worse
2. Freedom of streaming services
3. Effect on health / everyday life and habits
4. A way to save money
5. Common experience sharing the same show
6. Easier to find older films/series
7. Setting limits to control how much they watch

Step 3: Paragraph Focus

Read Elena's paragraph. Which ideas from the list above can you find? (2 questions are answered here) **Underline or highlight the phrases or sentences that helped you answer!**

Elena

I like the idea of having everything in one place, but I often end up wasting time deciding. I'll open an app intending to watch something and spend ages comparing trailers, reviews and "recommended" lists. And another thing — I ask my mates, have you watched "so-and-so" on Apple? And yeah, basically I'm the only Apple subscriber in the country. We used to get together after every new episode buzzing with ideas to discuss.

Check your answers:

Q1: Elena wastes "time deciding" and "spends ages comparing" — too much choice becomes unhelpful.

Q5: She describes missing shared viewing: "We used to get together... buzzing with ideas to discuss."

Step 4: Complete the rest of the task

We've already read Marcus's paragraph so this should be easy!

Try to match the other questions to each person

Marcus

Streaming suits me because it removes the timetable. If I'm busy, I can pause a film and finish it days later without missing anything, and I'm not at the whim of traditional broadcasting; that's totally the biggest change to my routine, I think. That and skipping the awful ads! I also enjoy the back catalogue — it used to be impossible to find classic movies. But, it's just so expensive having so many subscriptions at the same time!

Aisha

My problem isn't the content; it's having to use so many services to get everything you want. One subscription seems reasonable, but once you add a second or third, you're paying a lot for services you don't even use every week. I've started a strict system of rotating them: I cancel one, join another for a month, then switch again when there's something I want to watch. I have to say though — I do kinda miss just watching whatever's on without thinking about it. It's funny, my partner and I watch the same shows but each on our own devices.

Daniel

What concerns me is how easily streaming turns into a habit. The very flexibility that's supposed to be a benefit, with episodes lined up automatically, makes it hard to stop at a sensible time, even when you're tired. I've had nights where I planned to watch something short and ended up going to bed far too late. Now I set boundaries for myself — one episode, no "autoplay" — otherwise it affects my sleep and I feel less focused the next day.

Final Check!

- Each of the 7 questions has one answer.
- You have at least 1 answer per paragraph.
- You can point to a clear phrase that proves each match.

Practice Reading Task

Now try another task using the same strategies we've just practised!

Public Transport and Car Use

Four people respond in the comments section of an online magazine article about public transport and car use. Read the texts and answer the questions.

Chris

In an ideal world, I'd use public transport more. The reality where I live, a semi-rural area, is different. Buses run once an hour if you're lucky, and the nearest train station is a 20-minute drive away. Driving isn't just a preference; it's a necessity for managing my time between work, school runs, and family commitments. I'm not against the principle; in fact, I use trains for longer leisure trips. But for daily life, until there's a genuine, reliable alternative, the car is my only real option - I get it's terrible for the environment, though.

Nadia

Giving up my car was one of the best decisions I've made. Financially, it's been a huge relief: no more insurance, fuel costs, or parking fees. More importantly, my commute has become a chance to unwind; I can read, listen to podcasts, or just zone out instead of battling traffic. That said, it isn't perfect. When services are delayed or cancelled, it throws my entire schedule off, and during peak times it can feel a bit cramped. Still, for everyday travel, the benefits far outweigh the occasional hassle.

Liam

I'm definitely a big fan of incentivising greater public transport use. We should be actively discouraging unnecessary car use through policy and investment — think cleaner, more frequent buses and trains, plus safe cycling routes. I understand cars are vital for some due to mobility needs or poor infrastructure, but often they're used out of sheer habit. A shift in mindset, supported by reliable sustainable alternatives, is crucial for our cities' future.

Sofia

I'm what you'd call a pragmatic user — I choose the mode of transport that fits the specific trip. Commuting into the city? The train is a no-brainer; it's faster and I avoid congestion charges. But for a big weekly shop or visiting relatives in the countryside, the car is essential. My biggest gripe isn't with the services themselves, but with the ticketing. Prices seem to rise constantly, and the array of peak/off-peak, single/return, and contactless caps is needlessly confusing. Fairer pricing would persuade a lot more people like me to use it more often.

1. Who appreciates being able to use their travel time for leisure activities?

2. Who feels that where they live makes regular use of public transport impractical?

3. Who decides which transport to use based on the purpose and practicalities of each trip?

4. Who mentions that service unreliability can disrupt their plans?

5. Who argues that the environmental impact of transport should be a primary consideration?

6. Who finds the current fare structures pricey and overly complicated?

7. Who states they would use public transport more if it were a viable alternative?

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